

PROJECT CONCEPT FORM – Luke Miller

PROJECT NAME:	Care 2 Care From Aftercare to Careers
PROJECT LOCATION:	Pittsburgh, PA
ORIGINATOR OF CONCEPT:	Luke Miller, Consultant, GSPIA Non-Profit Clinic
PROPOSED SUPERVISOR:	Jordan Coughlen, CEO, Alpha House Inc.
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PROJECT PERIOD:	January 2021 – December 2024
SDGs Project Relates to	SDG 3: Good Health & Well-being SDG 8: Decent Work & Economic Growth
State & National Plans	Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration (SAMHSA/Federal) - SOAR - Projects for Assistance in Transition from Homelessness (PATH) - Evidence Based Practice for Supported Employment Program US Department of Labor - SUPPORT for Patients and Communities Act Department of Drug and Alcohol Programs (DDAP/State) - Family and Recovery Support Services - Employment Support Services
Bilateral Donors/Partners	American Job Center US Department of Labor's Employee and Training Administration SAMSHA
Local Organizations/Partners	Partner4Work Alpha House Inc. – Residential Substance Use Disorder Treatment Center

PROJECT BACKGROUND:

The Opioid Epidemic across the United States has led to a renewed focus on the treatment and reintegration of individuals suffering from Substance Use Disorder (SUD). There are many forms of treatment that exist to help people achieve abstinence, but this project focuses on the most effective treatment for “treatment-resistant populations” who exhibit confounding problems influencing their recovery: Therapeutic Communities (TCs). TCs are residential treatment centers that aid an individual suffering from SUD by helping them simultaneously address underlying mental illnesses and trauma. Research has shown that these communities are very effective in treating “treatment resistant populations” when Medically Assisted Treatment and Out-Patient Treatments often fail. Furthermore, studies have demonstrated that the greatest factors influencing TC success rates are a client’s length of stay in treatment, the presence of aftercare, post-treatment employment, and the influence of their social networks. “Care2Care” works as an extension of the TC model to extend the length of care, provide job training and employment experience, and to establish healthy networks for those in recovery through a transitional housing project that serves the community through its volunteer services .

PROJECT JUSTIFICATION:

Care2Care addresses a gap in care for people receiving addiction treatment services. While treatment is used as an opportunity for individuals to focus on their personal health and well-being, some treatment facilities do not have the ability to reintegrate their participants into society in a controlled manner. Often, this results in individuals leaving treatment without a job or proper housing, requiring them to return to their former social circles that may be unfavorable to their recovery. The burden of inefficient treatment to society is large. Substance use disorder correlates with involvement in the judicial system, disease, and often homelessness. Preparing individuals to provide for themselves helps ensure the sustainability of their treatment and their contributions to society.

PROJECT BENEFICIARIES AND STAKEHOLDERS:

The immediate beneficiaries of this project are the individuals who have recently received treatment in residential therapeutic communities. By preparing these individuals to meet their own basic needs, this project reduces the root causes of relapse. The secondary beneficiaries of this project are the families and friends of those receiving treatment. Pennsylvania recognized the difficulty in families supporting SUD members and implemented legislation that enables families to petition the state for forced intervention of SUD afflicted individuals. However, by enabling individuals to support themselves, this program reduces the burden on families as recipients return to society.

Stakeholders for this project include the partner TC – Alpha House Inc, which will provide management for the community. Secondly, the city and state have committed to the reduction of opioid dependence and have a large stake in the development of these programs. The alternative to successful treatment often results in welfare and recidivism – paid for by city and state resources.

While the only parties required for the program’s implementation are the hosting organization, the participants, and funding sources, government entities should entertain funding possibilities as they have grants to fund SUD reintegration efforts.

PROJECT GOAL:

This goal of this project is to increase the success rates of individuals leaving substance use treatment. As a result, those receiving treatment for Substance Use Disorder will maintain abstinence on their own accord, following completion of Care2Care. Specifically, we will aim for 50% of Care2Care participants to report a 6-month period of abstinence in the year after release.

PROJECT PURPOSE:

This project will seamlessly reintegrate rehabilitated SUDs back into society by preparing them with the skills they need for personal and economic stability. As a result, 2/3rds of Care2Care participants will secure employment after program completion and will maintain this employment at 6 months post-treatment.

PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION:

The project will include 5 components.

1. The creation of an affordable transitional housing facility ensuring a stable environment for program graduates.
2. An employment preparedness program that includes training with Partner4Work’s Transitional jobs program that prepares those with a judicial history for employment.
3. Mentoring internships between willing community partners and aftercare participants will be created to cover employment history gaps and to prepare individuals for steady employment while also introducing them to potential employers.
4. Continued access to Outpatient Treatment with Alpha House encourages ongoing self-dedication to a pro-social life.
5. Cash stipends to supplement individuals’ participation in the program. Additionally, these stipends will allow companies to take on the mentorships as free labor.

Participants will receive the incentives - housing and a living stipend - in return for their willingness to partner with the program, remain abstinent, and to continue outpatient therapy with the hosting organization: Alpha House Inc.

ASSUMPTIONS:

This project is heavily reliant on funding and partnership with local TC Alpha House Inc. Alpha House is a needed partner as both a source of clientele and a logical parent to the project. Additionally, Alpha House has partnerships that could prove advantageous. Funding opportunities are readily available at the federal and state level for addiction services and should be sought in addition to payments from Medicaid.

SUSTAINABILITY CRITERIA FOR OUTCOME:

The sustainability of this project will be helped by the partnerships with local companies that can benefit from the free labor provided through the mentorship program. Additionally, the partnerships that Alpha House Inc. currently has in place with local vendors can help sustain the welfare of the housing of Care2Care. While external funding sources will be necessary for the sustainability of outcomes, this burden can be lessened through partnerships. However, there is a substantial availability of funding in association with the opioid epidemic and residential transitional facilities from the State of Pennsylvania.

PROJECT TIMELINE AND BUDGET:

The project will take approximately 9 months to develop and reach full capacity, with start-up costs being the highest burden on the project in the first quarter. The project will develop across 4 phases: planning & start-up, patient intake & training services, mentorship program, & employment periods. At 9 months, the project is expected to be operating all aspects of its program and to have 10/12 beds filled.

The budget breakdown (See Figure 5) anticipates high costs in the first-year totaling \$71,200, before lowering to \$54,000 over the second and third year.

PROJECT EVALUATION AND GENERALIZABILITY:

Does housing stability, job training, and job mentorship generate consistent employment for former substance abusers, and does this employment result in increased long-term substance abstinence? As the IE question is two-fold, there are two potential opportunities for generalizability. Does job training, housing, and mentorship create stable employment for former substance abusers? And does stable employment support substance abstinence? As a result, this program's evaluation has the power to influence policy decisions and approaches to a highly afflicted and growing population.

IMPACT EVALUATION METHODOLOGY:

Care2Care aims to not only provide individuals with a job, but to ensure they retain their positions and that these positions result in substance use decrease and potentially abstinence. Therefore, the impact evaluation is only possible after *Care2Care* cohorts have been 6 months removed from the transitional housing facility. The impact evaluation will reveal and compare one's standing at 6 months removed from treatment. To ensure accuracy in evaluation, we will use a difference-in-differences approach that compares cohorts before and after the program became available. As this program highly encourages self-selection through incentives, we will assume that a similar participation rate would have occurred for both cohorts.

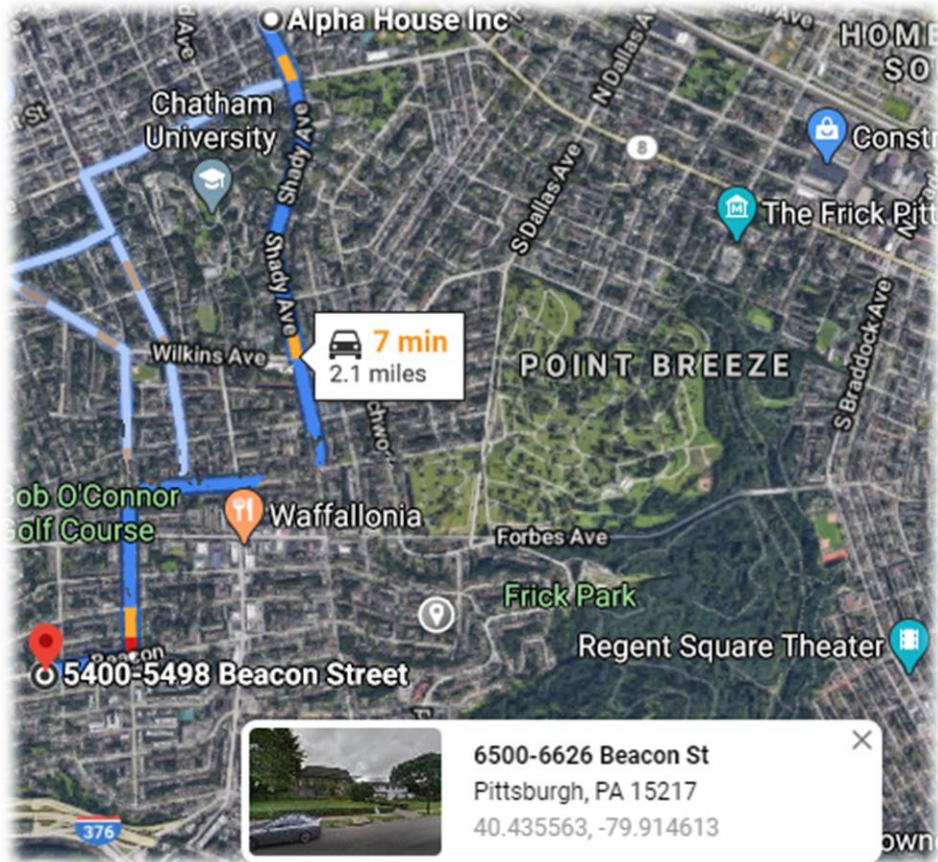
While an ideal comparison would match characteristics of both cohorts to strengthen the accuracy of the results, this program addresses a highly specialized population with unique histories. Therefore, to attempt to be inclusive to individuals' histories that impact their disorder, we will use their trauma scores prior to enrolling in treatment as a control. These ACE scores are collected by all individuals prior to beginning treatment at Alpha House and will help to deepen the understanding of the cohorts.

Through these methods, we believe *Care2Care* will demonstrate a large impact on an individual's path to a pro-social life following treatment for substance use disorder.

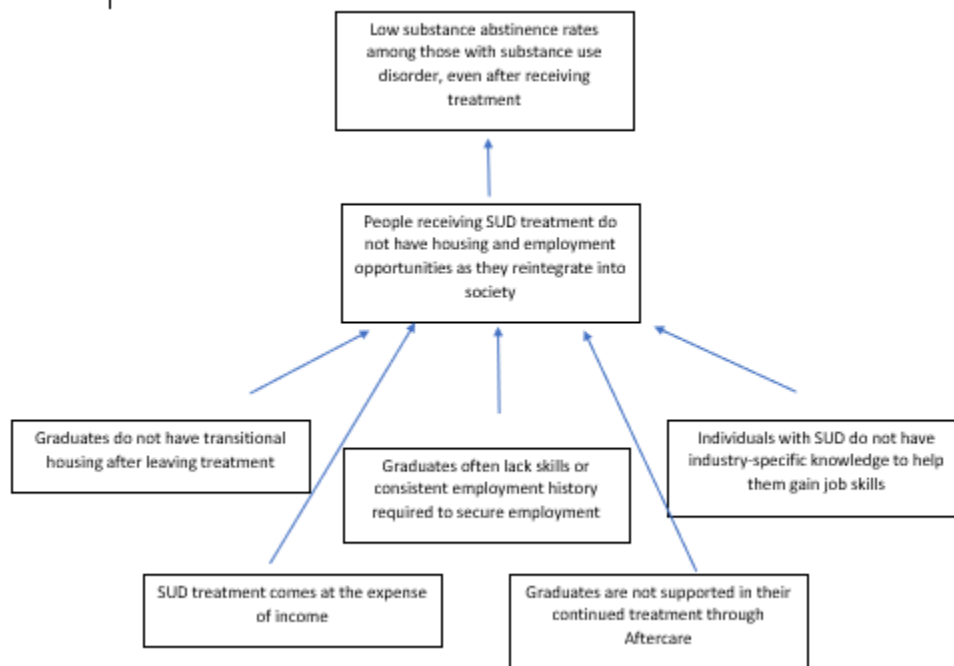
Appendix:

1. Map, situating the project in the city, country, and/or region
2. Problem Tree
3. Objectives Tree
4. Log-Frame
- 5a. Budget
- 5b. Implementation & Timeline

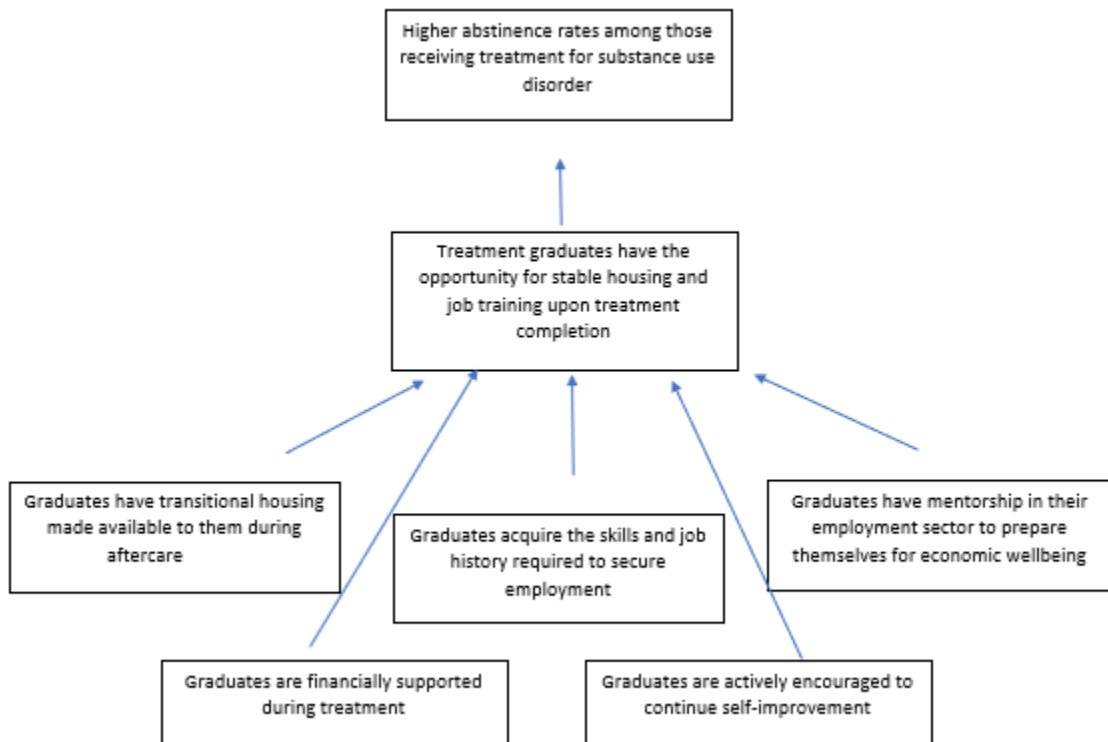
(1)



(2)
Problem Tree



(3)
Objectives Tree



(4)

Project Structure	Indicators	Means of Verification	Assumptions
Those receiving treatment for Substance Use Disorder maintain abstinence following graduation	50% of participants in the Care 2 Care program report 6-month abstinence in the year after release	6-month and 1-year phone interviews about use and employment history	
Treatment graduates are reintegrated into society with the employment skills they need to succeed	2/3 of individuals secure employment prior to leaving transitional housing and retain employment 6 months after graduation	Exit interviews are conducted with individuals prior to their departure	All relationships will be supportive in nature Mentorships will produce the skills needed for employment & sufficiently cover employment gaps
1. Halfway house apartments are made available to treatment graduates 2. Transitional Jobs Training Program are established 3. Participants are assigned employment mentors who accept intern responsibilities 4. Participants continue outpatient therapy 5. Stipends are provided to participants to encourage their participation and discourage secondary ventures	1. Each of the graduates leaving Alpha House has a transitional bed available to them for up to 6 months (up to 12 people at a time) 2. 90% of participants receive certificates from work training 3. Every program participant spends a minimum 1 month in employee mentorship 4. Ongoing therapy is mandated for participation in the program 5. Participants are actively self-selecting into the program	1. Number of rooms available in the halfway house 2. Certificates Received through Partner 4 Work 3. Measured through hours worked 4. Alpha House is seeing 100% attendance at therapy sessions from Care2Care 5. Alpha House graduates are self-selecting into Care2Care	Graduates self-select into the housing and reintegration program Partner4Work has the capacity to handle the clientele Employment partners are willing to accept mentorship roles for clients Stipends are used in a personally supportive manner.

Secure a housing facility suitable for the TC's graduates Find employment partnerships through Partner4Work and community groups Join Partner4Works' Transitional Employment Program Hire a manager to coordinate house and community service projects	<u>Costs</u> Living Stipend for Clients Food Rental and Utilities Coordinator Job Training partner	<u>Means</u>	Willingness among partnered organization, Alpha House, to burden managing responsibilities Employment opportunities exist for local organizations Trainings and capacity available from Partner4Work's Transitional employment services
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(5a)

Costs	Down	Monthly	Time period	Year 1 Total	Year 2 Total	Year 3 Total
Rent	2600	2600	Q1	31200	31200	31200
Utilities		300	Q1	3600	3600	3600
Van	4000	500	Starting Q2	8500	6000	6000
Coordinator		3500	Q1	42000	42000	42000
Client Stipend (\$500/month)		6,000	Starting Q3	36000	72000	72000
Startup		2,500	Q1	7500	0	0
Random Drug Testing		100	Starting Q2	900	1200	1200
Partner4Work Fees		1500	Starting Q2	13500	18000	18000
Net Costs				143200	174000	174000

(5b)

GANNT								
	2021 Q1	2021 Q2	2021 Q3	2021 Q4	2022 Q1	2022 Q2	2022 Q3	2022 Q4
Phase 1 - Planning & Startup	Start-Up: Hire a manager, secure a facility, make necessary adaption to the facility	Continue Making Adaption to Home as Needed						
Phase 2 - Patient Intake & Employment Services		Begin Taking Clients	Begin Taking Graduates	Beds Filled	Beds Filled	Beds Filled	Beds Filled	Beds Filled
		Begin Offering Training & Enrollment	Begin offering trainings	Trainings Offered	Trainings Offered	Trainings Offered	Trainings Offered	Trainings Offered
Phase 3 - Mentorship Program		Find Mentors	Find Mentors	Pair Mentors	Mentor Program Running	Mentor Program Running	Mentor Program Running	Mentor Program Running
Phase 4 - Employment Mentorship		Secure vehicle, partners, and materials for Employment Service	Secure vehicle, partners, and materials for Employment Service	Begin Pairing Graduates & Employers	Begin Pairing Graduates & Employers	Ongoing Employer Partnership	Ongoing Employer Partnership	Ongoing Employer Partnership